



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Bluegrass Christian Academy
School Website: <https://bluegrasschristianacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit Report: Bethel Classical Academy

School website used: <https://bethelclassical.org/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Bethel Classical Academy (Irvine, CA) presents strong textual evidence across nearly all elements of classical education: a confessedly Christ-centered telos; explicit emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty; a Trivium-centered, Latin-forward curriculum integrated with Western Civilization and humane letters; robust memory, copywork, catechism, and discussion/debate practices; and a clearly articulated partnership with parents. The only thinner area in public-facing materials is Faculty formation/portrait language (less explicit than other categories), though teacher bios echo formation in "wisdom and virtue." On balance, BCA's published materials align closely with the Six Essential Elements framework and associated positive/negative keyword indicators.

Note on method: This audit uses the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1)" keyword framework—positive/negative indicators for each category—to quantify textual signals before assigning ratings.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

- What we looked for (lexicon examples): truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; Scripture; worship/prayer/liturgy; chapel; catechesis; reverence; imago Dei (absence of moral relativism/values-neutral).
- Evidence from the site (verbatim cues):
 - Christ-centered Curriculum; "all knowledge ... points back to Him"; "Jesus Christ is Lord of all"; "biblical worldview" (theology integration)
 - "true, good, beautiful and noble"; "God as Truth and the source of all wisdom" (moral realism + metaphysical claims)
 - Statement of Faith: "study and observance of His Word, prayer, worship and the sacraments"; Holy Scripture as "supreme and final authority" (liturgical/communal practices + theology)
 - Community practices like "Fathers' Prayer Meeting" and "Prayers & Devotion" in curriculum sequence reinforce a worshipful rhythm
- Keyword comparison to "Six Elements"
 - Positive hits: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue/wisdom; biblical worldview; Christ-centered; Scripture; worship; prayer; sacraments (8+ distinct)
 - Negative hits: none observed

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- Quantification
 - Positive vs. negative: +12 / -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage (sub-elements present: moral realism, theology, liturgical practices): 0.90
 - Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- What we looked for: formation over information; cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; humane ends beyond mere careerism.
- Evidence from the site:
 - Goals: “appreciation of that which is true, good, beautiful”; equip students in “wisdom” under God as “Truth” (teleology and formation)
 - “love God and love learning” (formation of affections)
 - Teacher bio: Great Works to “cultivate wisdom and virtue” (explicit formation aim)
 - “raise lifelong learners who live to glorify God” (purpose language)
- Keyword comparison
 - Positive hits: wisdom, virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, love of learning (6+ distinct)
 - Negative hits (e.g., workforce-first): none observed
- Quantification
 - Positive vs. negative: +6 / -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage: 0.95
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- What we looked for: Trivium/Quadrivium; Latin/Greek; great books/primary sources; history (not “social studies”); integrated/humane letters; wonder.
- Evidence from the site:
 - Trivium with Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric described and implemented; “students study complete literary works instead of textbooks” (Great Books approach)
 - Latin begins in lower school; continues through Logic School (Latin 1, Latin 2)
 - Humane Letters sequence; Logic/Rhet (LTW, Progymnasmata)
 - History taught explicitly as History (OT/Egypt; Greece/Rome; Middle Ages/Reformation; Explorers–Modern), not “Social Studies”
 - Memory strand includes Bible verses, poems, catechisms (supports oral tradition/recitation)
- Keyword comparison
 - Positive hits: Trivium, Latin, Logic, Rhetoric, Progym, Humane Letters, Great Works/Western Civilization, Memory/Catechism, Poetry; Astronomy and Music electives appear (Quadrivium touchpoints) (10+ distinct)
 - Negative hits (e.g., “social studies,” STEM-first framing): none observed
- Quantification
 - Positive vs. negative: +12 / -0
 - Percent positive: 1.00
 - Coverage: 0.95
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

- What we looked for: memorization/recitation/chanting; singing; copywork/imitation/progymnasmata; Socratic discussion/debate/seminar; restful learning (scholé); upper-school rhetoric via speeches/debates/orations.
- Evidence from the site:
 - Lower School memory strand (Scripture/poetry/catechisms) indicates regular recitation; copywork embedded in writing sequence (imitation)
 - Logic years: “discussion based” and “introduced to debate”; “informal logic” (dialectic)
 - Logic/Rhet track shows LTW + Progym (classical composition/imitative exercises) and “Rhet” naming (oratory preparation)
 - Music/Choir listed as electives (singing tradition present)
 - Note: The exact term “Socratic” and explicit “scholé/restful” language are not found, though practices imply discussion/recitation and oratory preparation.
- Keyword comparison
 - Positive hits: memorization, recitation (catechism/poetry), copywork (imitation), discussion/debate, Progym, rhetoric, choir/singing (6–7 distinct)
 - Negative hits: none observed
- Quantification
 - Positive vs. negative: +6 / -0
 - Percent positive: 0.85
 - Coverage: 0.80
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

- What we looked for: teachers as models/mentors; “living curriculum”; collegial faculty culture; explicit “portrait of a teacher/student”; faculty classical formation.
- Evidence from the site:
 - Teacher bios emphasize classical formation aims (e.g., “cultivate wisdom and virtue,” truth/goodness/beauty; Torrey Honors—Great Books pedigree)
 - Public pages do not yet articulate a formal “portrait of a teacher,” faculty collegium, or explicit teacher formation program.
- Keyword comparison
 - Positive hits: wisdom/virtue emphasis; great books formation; Christian witness (3–4 distinct)
 - Negative hits: none observed
- Quantification
 - Positive vs. negative: +3 / -0
 - Percent positive: 0.75
 - Coverage: 0.50
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- What we looked for: parent partnership/co-teaching; parent formation (book groups/workshops); open hospitality; community worship/feasts; communication of classical philosophy.
- Evidence from the site:
 - “Parent Partnership ... we work together with parents as a community of faith” (explicit)
 - Parent formation and alignment in admissions (“parents are required to have read ... prior to the family interview” and families assessed for “support and partnership” and classical understanding)

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- Ongoing parent/community life: Parent Workshop: Reading; Fathers' Prayer Meeting; Moms and Muffins; Dads and Donuts (hospitality and spiritual community)
 - "We encourage you as parents to be part of our school community through different volunteer capacities" (explicit volunteer invitation)
 - Keyword comparison
 - Positive hits: parent partnership, family involvement, parent formation/reading, prayer gatherings, community events (6–7 distinct)
 - Negative hits: none observed
 - Quantification
 - Positive vs. negative: +7 / -0
 - Percent positive: 0.90
 - Coverage: 0.90
 - Rating: CLASSICAL
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Aggregate Classification

- Category ratings: [1] CLASSICAL, [2] CLASSICAL, [3] CLASSICAL, [4] CLASSICAL, [5] SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, [6] CLASSICAL
- Overall: CLASSICAL

Rationale: The preponderance of positive classical indicators across telos, curriculum, pedagogy, and parent partnership strongly supports a Classical designation. Faculty language, while favorable, is the least explicit and could be strengthened.

Recommendations to Strengthen Alignment (Faculty focus)

- Publish a "Portrait of a Teacher" and "Portrait of a Graduate" that names virtues (prudence, justice, temperance, fortitude; humility; intellectual virtues) and commitments (lifelong learning; collegiality), aligning to classical faculty keywords.
 - Describe faculty formation rhythms (e.g., great books seminars, commonplacing, catechesis-in-faculty meetings, retreats) to make the "living curriculum" visible.
 - Highlight mentorship language (teacher as "model," "guide," "sage") and any peer-observation or Socratic coaching among faculty.
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Evidence Index (select pages cited)

- Christ-centered curriculum; Trivium; TGB: "Christ-centered Curriculum ... truth, goodness, and beauty" and Trivium explanation
 - Our Story (true/good/beautiful; God as Truth; wisdom):
 - Statement of Faith (Scripture, prayer, worship, sacraments):
 - Curriculum tables (Latin; memory/catechism; poetry; logic/rhet; humane letters; choir):
 - Parent Partnership page; parent events/workshops:
 - Faculty bios (wisdom and virtue; great works):
 - Framework/lexicon reference used: Six Essential Elements keywords and classical lexicon
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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